

Your patient sheet

Week 1 · Foundations of Physiology

Camila Reyes. 19 years old. Second year kinesiology student and a midfielder on the college soccer team. No prior medical history, no medications. She is the same patient for everyone in the class, and the same patient every week. What you choose is your entry point, and you keep that too.

01 Foundations of Physiology

Preseason physical · August 12 · Six weeks before she got sick.

Nothing is wrong yet. This is the only chart entry in the term where every number is normal, which is exactly what makes it the most useful one. Everything you read for the next fourteen weeks gets compared to this page.

The chart

VITALS

HR 52, BP 108/64, RR 12, temperature 36.8 °C (98.2 °F), SpO₂ 99% on room air.

MEASUREMENTS

Weight 61 kg (134 lb), height 168 cm (5 ft 6 in).

LABS

Sodium 139 mEq/L, potassium 4.2, chloride 103, bicarbonate 25, glucose 88 mg/dL, creatinine 0.8 mg/dL, hemoglobin 13.4 g/dL, hematocrit 40%.

NOTE

Well. Cleared for full participation. No symptoms, no medications, no family history she knows of.

On your desk

Choose an entry point above and this fills in with the data your discipline would have, plus the question written from that desk.

Work it through

Five questions, the same five every week. The bullets under each are the moves, not decoration: do them in that order.

1. Name three variables in this chart that are actively regulated. For each one, say what quantity is being held steady and what control system is holding it.

- Be precise about the noun. Not "the pressure" but which pressure, not "the enzyme" but which one and where it works.
- Say what is doing the regulating, by name.
- If you cannot name it in one line, that is the gap. Write the line anyway and mark it.

2. Her resting heart rate is 52. Say whether that is a finding or a baseline, and say exactly what you would need to know to decide.

- Commit to a direction before you explain anything. Up, down, or held steady.
- Write the prediction as a sentence, not an arrow.
- You are allowed to be wrong here. You are not allowed to skip it.

3. Explain what a reference range is a range of. Then say why a value inside it is not proof of health, and a value outside it is not proof of disease.

- Go in order. Do not jump from cause to outcome.
- Name every step, including the one that feels obvious.
- Where a step is a guess, write "I think" in front of it so you can find it later.

One row per step, in the order it happens. Add rows on your own paper if you need more.

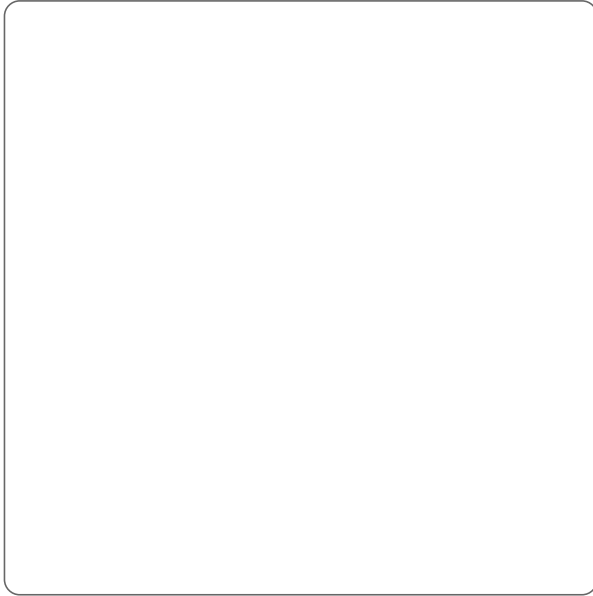
STEP 1	
STEP 2	
STEP 3	
STEP 4	
STEP 5	

Now say it in prose, in four or five sentences, using the rows above in order.

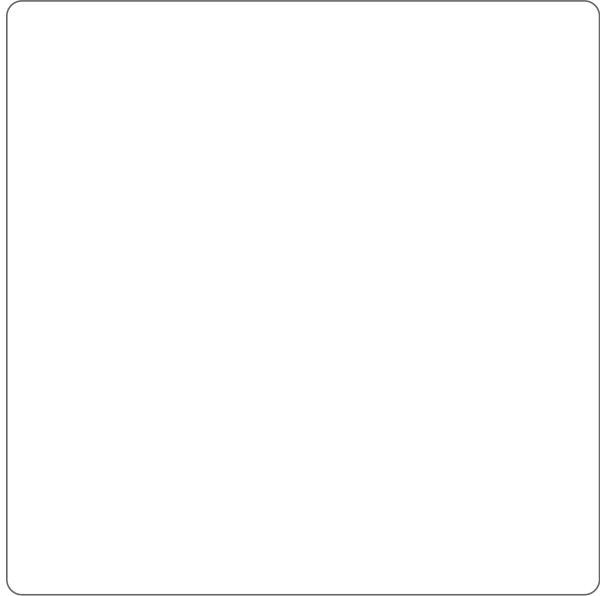
4. Interpret this chart. Say what it shows and what it cannot show.

- Split the page: what the evidence shows, and what you are inferring from it.
- Both are allowed. Mixing them is what costs marks.
- Name the single number that did the most work in your answer.

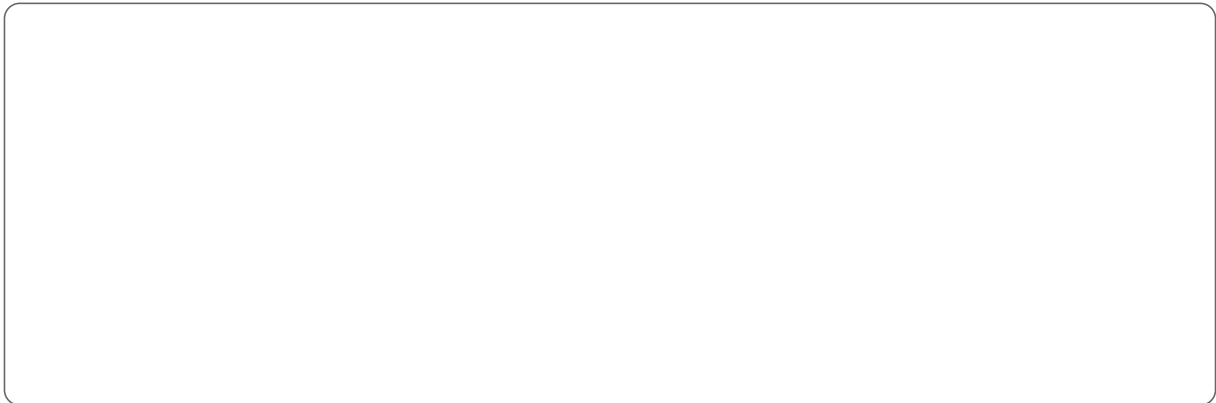
What the evidence shows



What it cannot show



The one number that did the most work in your answer, and why



5. Name the one measurement you would add to this baseline today, and say what question it would let you answer in October.

- Two sentences of conclusion, no more.
- Then the measurement that would change your mind, and which way the result would have to go.
- A conclusion nothing could overturn is not a conclusion.

Your conclusion, two sentences

The measurement that would change it, and which way the result would have to go

Before you close this week

- One line: what changed in your thinking about this patient since last week.
- "Nothing changed" is a real answer if you say why that is informative.

AI disclosure. What you used it for, and what you did with what it gave you. One line saying you used none is a complete answer.

Keep every week. In Week 15 you will be asked to read her first blood gas again using things you will not learn until November, and the only way to do that well is to still have what you wrote in September.